

Columna

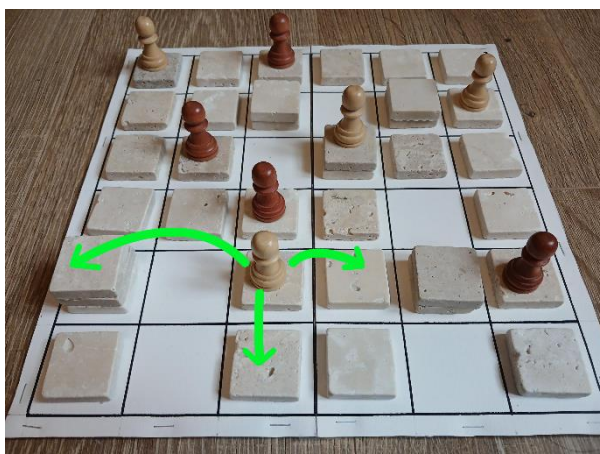
2025, Xavier Bultel, <https://bultel.info/Columna.html>

The game is played on the following board and initial setup:



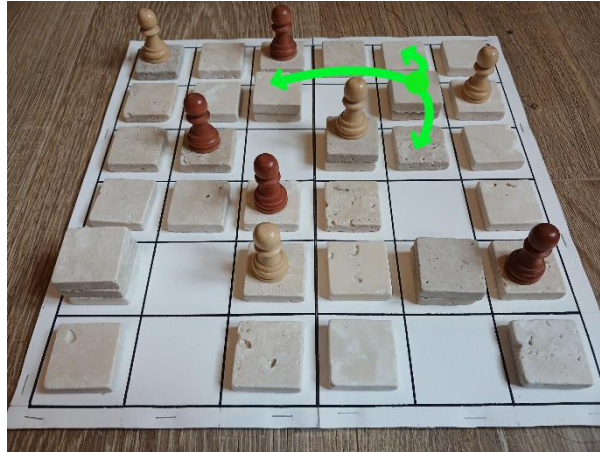
On each turn, a player must perform the following two actions in order:

1. The player must move one of their pieces from one stack of tiles to another, in an orthogonal direction (forward, backward, left, or right — never diagonally). The move must go to the first stack encountered in the chosen direction. Empty squares are not considered stacks. The destination stack must not already contain a piece



move example

2. The player must then choose an unoccupied stack and move it onto another unoccupied stack, again in an orthogonal direction. The move goes to the first stack encountered in that direction. The resulting stack must contain no more than five tiles



moving stacks example

All tiles from the starting square are moved (that square becomes empty for the rest of the game)

The game ends when a player is unable to perform a required action. The winner is:

- the player with the most pieces on stacks of five tiles
- in case of a tie, compare stacks of four tiles, then three, and so on

If both players have pieces on stacks of the same sizes, the loser is the player who could not complete the required action.



In this position, the black pieces are on two stacks of height 5, one stack of height 3, and one stack of height 1. The white pieces are on two stacks of height 5, one stack of height 4, and one stack of height 1.

There is a tie on the stacks of height 5, but the white player has more pieces on stacks of height 4 than the black player and therefore wins the game.